

Making things move

Computer games are all about firing, dodging, catching, and escaping. Characters might run, fly spaceships, or drive fast cars. To create great games in Scratch, you first need to learn how to make sprites move.

SEE ALSO

◀ 28–29 Sprites

Co-ordinates 56–57 ▶

Motion blocks

The dark blue “Motion” blocks make sprites move. Start a new project by clicking the “File” menu and choosing “New.” The new project begins with the cat in the middle of the stage, ready for action.

Scratch won't let sprites walk off the stage, so you'll never lose us.

1 First steps

Drag the “move 10 steps” block from the “Motion” section of the blocks palette and drop it into the scripts area to its right. Each time you click the block, the cat moves.

move 10 steps

Click the white window on the block and type in a different number to change how far the cat moves

2 Keep on moving

Drag a yellow “forever” block from the blocks palette and drop it around the “move 10 steps” block. Click the green flag on the stage to run the program. The cat moves until it hits the edge of the stage.

when clicked

forever

move 10 steps

Add this block to tell Scratch when to start running the script

The “forever” block repeats anything inside it endlessly

3 Bouncing

Drag an “if on edge, bounce” block inside your “forever” block. Now the cat bounces when it hits the edge of the stage. The cat is upside down when it walks to the left.

when clicked

forever

move 10 steps

if on edge, bounce

Try changing 10 to 30 to make the cat sprint!

This block makes the cat turn around when it hits the edge of the stage



EXPERT TIPS

Rotation styles

Find the cat in the “Sprites” list in the bottom left of the screen. Click the “i” button in the top left of the frame. Here you'll find a button to change the cat's rotation style—so it doesn't walk around on its head!



The cat faces the direction it's walking in, sometimes upside down.



The cat faces left or right, and is always the right way up.



The cat doesn't rotate at all.

